

A GUIDE FOR BUSINESSES · 2026 EDITION

It's not **whether** to use AI, it's **how**.

A practical guide to understanding where artificial intelligence stands today, the risks it brings to your business, and how to harness it without losing control of your data.

What's inside

The state of AI · The cost of doing nothing · The risks of the cloud · The alternatives · How to protect yourself and implement it.

Where AI stands today

In just two years, artificial intelligence has gone from curiosity to everyday work tool. Models read documents, write, summarize, code and answer complex questions about a company's specific information.

It's no longer technology reserved for large corporations. Today a small or mid-sized business can build an assistant on its own data at a fraction of last year's cost. And according to **PwC**, early adopters already see a measurable wage premium and productivity jump.

The question is no longer whether AI will change your industry. It's what role you want to play when it does.

≈4×

Higher productivity growth in the sectors most exposed to AI.

+56%

Wage premium for professionals with AI skills.

AI has stopped being an optional advantage. It's becoming **the new baseline** on which businesses compete.

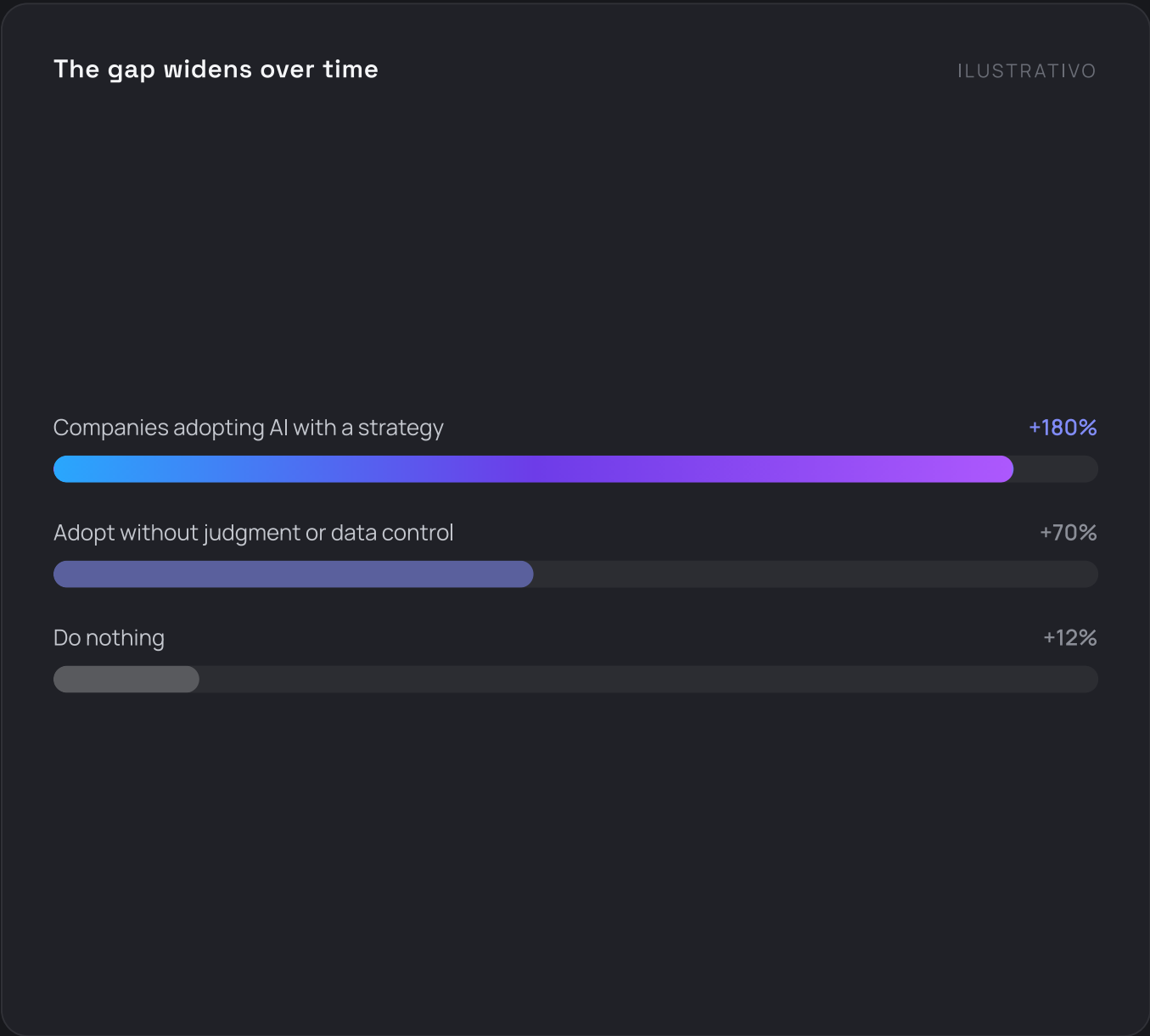
The danger of not acting

Not adopting AI doesn't keep you where you are — it leaves you behind. The advantage compounds. Every month a company waits, its competitors accumulate data, refined processes and experience that later become very hard to catch up on.

Higher costs
You keep paying for manual hours your competitors have already automated.

Talent walks away
The best people want to work where the tools are up to date.

A gap hard to close
By the time you react, whoever started earlier already has data and processes you don't.



The risk of uploading your data to the cloud

The fastest way to adopt AI — plugging your business into someone else's cloud and uploading your data — is also the riskiest. These are the three dangers almost no one explains.

01 Privacy and confidentiality

Every document you upload can end up training someone else's model, or exposed in a breach. Your knowledge — and your clients' — outside your control.

02 Vendor dependence

A price change, new terms or a shutdown, and your operation stops. You rented your intelligence; you don't own it.

03 Loss of your edge

If your data lives in someone else's cloud, so does your competitive moat. You give away exactly what made you hard to copy.

The takeaway → it's not about avoiding AI, but adopting it without giving up control of your data. That's where the alternatives begin.

Three ways to adopt AI

Not every option strikes the same balance between speed, cost and control. Here's the honest comparison.

OPTION A

Public cloud (API)

Fast to start and no infrastructure. But your data leaves home and you depend on the vendor.

Fast

Low control

OPTION B

Self-hosted open model

You run open models on your own server. Full data control, but it demands a technical team and maintenance.

High control

Needs a team

OPTION C · RECOMMENDED

Sovereign AI with RAG

The AI answers by consulting your documents, inside your perimeter. Full control, without shouldering all the complexity yourself.

Full control

Traceable

How to protect yourself, in one line

Keep **data sovereignty**: let the model work on your information without it ever leaving your control. That's the protection no third-party clause can guarantee you.

How to implement it

You don't need to reinvent the company. A good system starts with one concrete pain point and expands once it has proven its value.

01 Start with one use case

Pick a repetitive, measurable task: support, quotes, internal search.

02 Organize your data

Gather the documents the AI will need. Their quality shapes the result.

03 Decide where the model lives

Prioritize keeping your data under your control. Sovereignty by default.

04 Measure and expand

Quantify the hours saved and take what works to the next process.

WHERE IT'S HEADING

Models will get cheaper and more capable, moving from answering to **acting** on their own (agents). When intelligence becomes a commodity within everyone's reach, the only thing that will set your company apart is **your data**. Whoever controls it controls the advantage.

The opportunity cost, in numbers

Before choosing a tool, put a number on the problem. An employee costs a company around **€30,000 a year**. And it only takes AI saving them **15 minutes a day** for the math to change — the more it saves, the greater the return.

€30,000

Average annual cost of one employee.

≈€17/h

Cost per hour (about 1,720 h/year).

15 min/day

Time AI saves each employee.

≈60 h/yr

What those minutes add up to, per employee.

WITH JUST 15
MINUTES A DAY
SAVED

And that's the minimum. Every extra minute AI recovers goes straight to your bottom line.

≈€1,000

recovered / employee · year

≈€5,000

for a team of 5 · year

Quick glossary

The eight terms you need to follow any conversation about AI — no jargon.

Generative AI

Models that create text, images or code from an instruction.

RAG

The AI answers by consulting **your** documents, not just what it learned from the internet.

Agent

An AI that doesn't just answer: it carries out tasks for you (search, draft, update).

Hallucination

When the AI states something false with confidence. Source-backed RAG greatly reduces it.

LLM

Large language model: the engine, trained on huge amounts of text, that understands and writes.

Fine-tuning

Retraining a model on your data to specialize it for your business.

On-premise / sovereign

The AI runs on your own infrastructure; your data never leaves your control.

Token

The unit in which the AI "reads" text and by which its cost is measured.

Myths vs. reality

The five beliefs that hold most small businesses back — and what really happens.

MYTH

"AI is only for large companies."

REALITY

Today a small business builds an assistant on its data for a fraction of last year's cost.

MYTH

"I need my own technical team."

REALITY

You start with one use case and the technology partner shoulders the complexity.

MYTH

"I have too little data for it to work."

REALITY

RAG works precisely with yours: you don't need millions, you need the right ones.

MYTH

"It's far too expensive."

REALITY

Costs have plummeted; the return on a single use case often beats the investment in months.

MYTH

"I upload my data to the cloud and it's solved."

REALITY

That's where the risk begins: privacy, dependence and loss of your edge. Sovereignty avoids it.

Let's start with a call

No commitment. We book a first call, talk about the current state of your data, and define the next steps together.

01

A first call

30 minutes, no commitment, to get to know each other.

02

The state of your data

We look at what information you have today and what can be put to use.

03

The next steps

We define together where to start and what to expect.

THERE IS A SOLUTION

Everything above, solved — with your data **under your control.**

Zaviren implements sovereign AI with RAG for your business: the models work on your documents, inside your perimeter, without your information ever going to a third party's cloud. You start with one concrete use case and expand once you see the result.

Sovereign

Your data never leaves your control. And it trains no one.

Verifiable

Every answer cites your source. No hallucinations.

At your pace

One use case first. Expand when it works.

Let's see it with your data

A demo or a 30-minute call to see which use case makes sense to start with in your company.

Book a call

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